

Edward Tait

Composer, Pianist & Educator, based in London.

Composition Performance Highlights

Frühlingslied – Ansel Chaloner-Hughes, Christ Church Worthing (2026)

Dovetail – workshop/performance with Ewan Campbell & Marsyas Trio, Murray Edwards College, Cambridge (2026)

Ashes Beneath the Ice – Pavel Kushnir Scholarship “Music of War” Concert, Leighton House, Holland Park (2026)

Engineer’s Paradise – workshop with Simon Callaghan, Clíodna Shanahan & Richard Sisson, Conway Hall Clements Prize (2026)

Fleeting Manhattan – Rotherham Symphony Orchestra, Rotherham Minster (2025)

In the Bleak Midwinter – masterclass with Phillip Cooke, London Festival of Contemporary Church Music; subsequently performed at Holy Sepulchre Church (2025)

Prelude – Arquia Duo, St John’s Church Fulham (2025)

Rhapsody – London Sinfonietta, *Sound Out 2025*, Royal Festival Hall (2025)

HexRAMeron – Students Create Festival, Royal Academy of Music (2025)

In the Bleak Midwinter – Lloyd’s Choir, Katharine Cree Church (2024)

Ballade – commissioned and performed by Trio Amabile, York Late Music (2024)

Fantasy of the Night – workshop with Robert Saxton & Peter Sheppard-Skærved, who gave the premiere, Purcell School (2024)

Rhapsody – London Sinfonietta, Dugdale Arts Centre, *Sound Out Schools* (2024)

Fleeting Manhattan – Nicholas Daniel & Orion Orchestra, Smith Square Hall (2024)

Passage of Time – Carducci Quartet, Chiltern Arts Festival (2023)

Waltzing Matilda – Westminster Abbey, Commonwealth Day Pre-Service (2023)

Mo Li Hua – Purcell Sinfonietta, Hatfield House Music Festival (2022)

Additional performances in Royal Academy of Music composition concerts (2024–26), Purcell School composition concerts (2018–26).

Projects & Research

After the Crossing (2026)

Six site-specific organ improvisations responding to the distinctive qualities of each organ, church and surrounding landscape, presented within solo organ recitals across the Isle of Wight alongside Purcell, Elgar and original music.

ImprovForty (2024–25)

Recorded and released solo improvisations for 40 consecutive days to develop pianistic fluency; followed by *Scriabivisions*, exploring improvisation in the styles of Scriabin’s compositional periods.

Composers Parallels (2024)

Two chamber works by Edward Tait & Antonia Zadrag responding to Shostakovich, performed alongside two of his works at the **Purcell Pulse Festival** (2024). Followed by a 2026 Bach-inspired collaboration with Jacques Cohen and Purcell School composers, workshopped/performed by Shirley Turner (violin), Peter Mallinson (viola) & Richard Pearce (piano).

Employment & Work Experience

Artistic Director, MetroLand Music Festival (2026–)

Programming and organising weekly concerts; curating, stage management, publicity, programme design, social media, fundraising and bookkeeping. **Canva**, **Microsoft Excel**.

Sub-Team Representative, Royal Academy of Music Student Union (2026–27)

Student representation, RAM football club recruitment, freshers' assembly welcome events, social events and student networking; facilitating connections for collaborative projects and opportunities.

Resident Composer, Royal Academy of Music Widening Participation Composers Club (2026)

Composition workshops and supervision; interactive assemblies and GCSE composition mentoring.

Accompanist, Heatherton Singers (2025–)

Choral accompanying, tuning, sight-reading and keyboard arranging.

Resident Composer, London Sinfonietta Sound Out Schools (2024)

Composition workshops and supervision, notation software assistance, chamber orchestration and outreach mentoring.

Education & Training

Royal Academy of Music, London

BMus in Composition, First Class (2024–28) — Professors: Gareth Moorcraft, Louise Drewett

Electives: Keyboard Skills (Nicholas Walker), Conducting (Dominic Grier)

Academic study: Analytical Skills (Emily Kilpatrick, Alex Hills); Aural Skills (Jennifer Sheppard, Christopher Atkinson); Multimedia & Creative Technology (Phil Dawson); Notation (Ash Mistry, Gareth Lockrane); Orchestration & Repertoire (Louise Drewett); Techniques of Composition (Gareth Moorcraft).

Additional composition lessons: Eleanor Alberga, Rubens Askenar, Morgan Hayes, Philip Cashian, Edmund Finnis.

Seminars: Huw Watkins, Augusta Read Thomas, Hans Abrahamsen, Christian Mason, Anna Meredith, Ryan Latimer.

Annual large-ensemble workshops with Aaron Holloway-Nahum & Philip Cashian.

Leadership in performer coordination publicity for the B2/3 Composers Concert (2025).

Competitions, Awards

Winner, National Centre for Early Music Young Composer Award (2026) — *my troubled sense doth move*; workshop/performance with Christopher Fox & Gonzaga Band

Winner, London Festival of Contemporary Church Music Call-for-Scores (2025)

Shortlist, Conway Hall Clements Prize for Composers (2025)

Shortlist, European Recording Orchestra Call for Scores (2024)

Last Updated: 11th July 2027